

(–3) (+) (–4) = –7

To add (–3) and (–4) we pick 3 pink tokens first and 4 pink tokens later. The total number of tokens is 7 pink tokens. There are no zero pairs. So, the sum of (–3) and (–4) is (–7). Teacher can give different integers and ask them to add using tokens.

Note

1. When we add two integers of the same sign the sum will also be an integer of the same sign. When we add two integers of different sign, the sum will be the difference between the two integers and have the sign of the integer with greater value.
2. The integer wihtout sign represents positive integer.

Example 1.1

Add the following integers using number line (i) 10 and –15 (ii) –7 and –9

Solution Let us add the intergers using number line

(i) 10 and –15

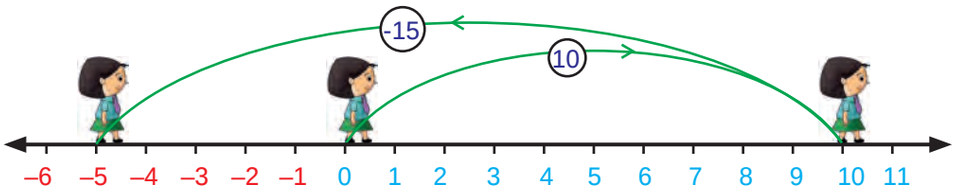


Fig. 1.7

On the number line we first start at zero facing positive direction and move 10 steps forward, reaching 10. Then we move 15 steps backward to represent –15 and reach at –5. Thus, we get 10 + (–15) = –5.

(ii) –7 and –9

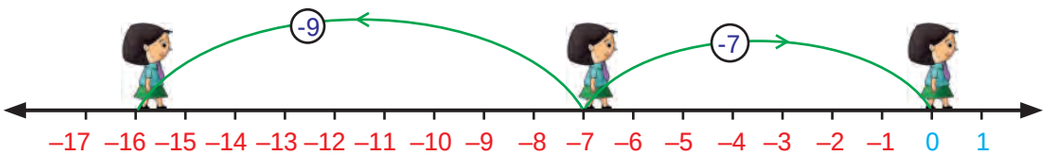


Fig. 1.8

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